

CONFIDENTIAL ASSESSMENT REPORT

Zero Trust Data Access Maturity Assessment

Prepared for

test

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CURRENT MATURITY LEVEL

2

Identity-Centric Security



L1



L2



L3



L4



L5

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

test is at

Level 2: Identity-Centric Security

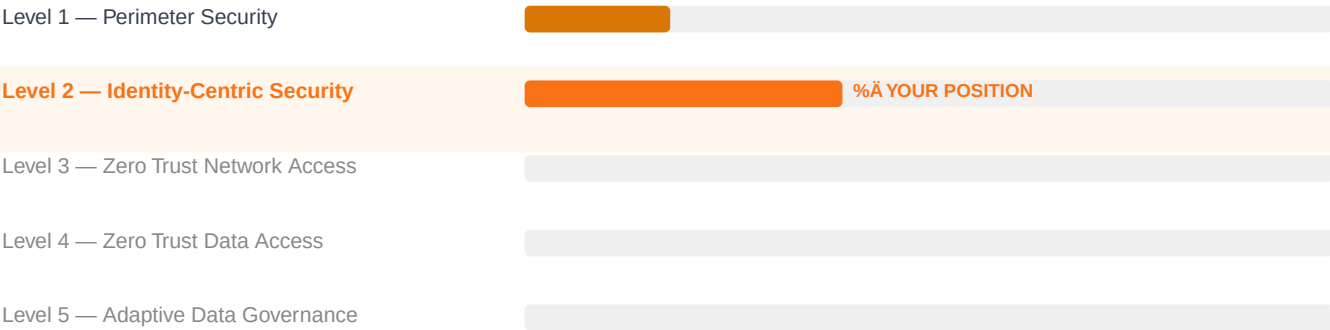
Your organization has made significant progress by implementing identity-based security controls. MFA, IAM, and conditional access policies provide strong user verification, significantly reducing account-based attack vectors.

YOUR NEXT STEP

Level 3: Zero Trust Network Access

Your organization has embraced Zero Trust Network Access principles, enabling secure application access without implicit network trust. This is a meaningful step forward, though the data layer remains an opportunity for further improvement.

ZERO TRUST MATURITY ROADMAP



SCORE BREAKDOWN BY CATEGORY

Identity & Access Foundation 5 / 7



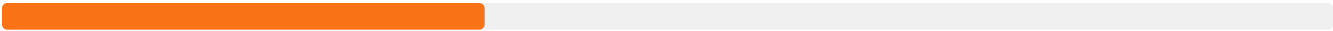
Partial coverage — identity & access foundation controls are in progress with clear room for advancement.

Zero Trust Network Access 1 / 8



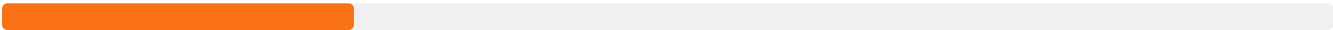
Zero Trust Network Access represents a key opportunity for maturity advancement in your Zero Trust journey.

Data Access & Collaboration 7 / 17



Data Access & Collaboration represents a key opportunity for maturity advancement in your Zero Trust journey.

Data Governance 3 / 10



Data Governance represents a key opportunity for maturity advancement in your Zero Trust journey.

WHAT YOUR ORGANIZATION IS DOING WELL

- Strong identity foundation with robust MFA enforcement and centralized IAM — the cornerstone of a Zero Trust architecture.
- Some data access controls exist, indicating an awareness of the need to protect data beyond the network perimeter.

IDENTIFIED GAPS & OPPORTUNITIES

The following areas represent opportunities to advance your Zero Trust Data Access maturity:

Heavy reliance on VPN grants remote users broad network-level access — meaning a single compromised session exposes your entire internal network to lateral movement. Modern ransomware attacks routinely exploit this exact vector to achieve organization-wide compromise, encrypting servers and backups across the enterprise. VPN-based architectures have been directly implicated in some of the most damaging breaches of the past five years.

Your remote users require full network-level access to reach applications, which means every remote session carries the risk of full network exposure if the endpoint is compromised. Without application-specific access controls, a single infected laptop can give an attacker a foothold to reach every system on your network — an attack surface that is simply too large to defend effectively.

Sensitive documents shared as email attachments are permanently beyond your control the moment they are sent — they can be forwarded, saved to personal devices, printed, or accessed indefinitely after an employee leaves or a vendor is breached. In regulated industries, a single improperly distributed document can trigger compliance violations, regulatory fines, and civil liability. You have no visibility into who has opened the file, who they shared it with, or whether it still exists on systems outside your control.

Every file copy sent to an external party is data you no longer control. When a vendor is breached, acquired, or an employee departs, your sensitive information goes with them — and you have no way to recover it or prevent further distribution. Third-party data breaches caused by oversharing are now one of the most common and costly sources of enterprise data loss, with average breach costs exceeding \$4 million when a third party is involved.

Without complete audit trails, you cannot prove what happened — or did not happen — to sensitive data after the fact. In the event of a breach, incomplete logs are themselves a compliance violation that regulators treat seriously: they limit your ability to scope the incident, notify affected parties within required timeframes, and defend against liability. Clients, insurers, and auditors are increasingly demanding evidence of complete access logging as a baseline expectation.

When vendor relationships end or security incidents occur, third-party access that cannot be revoked immediately becomes indefinite exposure. In supply chain attacks — now among the most destructive breach vectors — compromised third parties with lingering access have caused catastrophic losses at organizations far larger and better-resourced than most. Every day of delayed revocation is a day an attacker retains a foothold inside your data environment.

Full Zero Trust Data Access — where sensitive files can be shared externally with granular permissions, instant revocation, and without distributing file copies — has not yet been achieved. Without a purpose-built platform, every external share creates data you no longer control, every vendor with file access represents a lingering risk, and every document sent by email or cloud link becomes permanently unrecoverable. This gap exists regardless of how strong your identity and network controls are, and it is the single most impactful step remaining on your Zero Trust journey.

RECOMMENDATIONS

1

Evaluate Zero Trust Network Access solutions such as Microsoft Entra Private Access, Zscaler, or Cloudflare to begin replacing VPN-based remote access with application-specific, identity-verified connectivity.

2

Pilot ZTNA for a subset of remote workers or high-risk applications to validate the approach before broader rollout.

Integrate your existing IAM platform with ZTNA to ensure access decisions leverage identity posture and device compliance in real time.

Replace email attachment and cloud link sharing for sensitive documents with a controlled access platform that maintains organizational custody of data after every share — with real-time revocation and full audit trails.

Deploy a Zero Trust Data Access solution such as FileFlex Enterprise to close your Zero Trust Data Access gap. ZTDA enables your organization to access, collaborate and share sensitive files externally with granular, real-time permissions — with immediate access revocation at any time, zero file copies leaving your environment, and a complete audit trail of every access event.

READY TO ADVANCE TO THE NEXT LEVEL?

See How FileFlex Can Close Your Data Access Gaps

FileFlex Enterprise delivers Zero Trust Data Access — enabling granular file permissions, instant revocation, and secure external collaboration without data transfer.

[Request a Demo](#)

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